Salomon van Ruysdael
1628-1682

A river estuary with figures pulling in their nets by a fort, wijdships at a footbridge and other vessels beyond, probably Valkhof in Nijmegen

Signed with monogram and dated lower right: SvR 1645
74 x 109 cm.

Provenance:
Possibly Anonymous sale (William Beckford, Fonthill), Christie's London, 27 February 1802, lot 35
The rev. E.H. Dawkins, Christie's London, 28 February 1913, lot 88 (sold to A. Wertheimer)
Mrs. Ann Marks, Hammill Farm, United Kingdom

Literature:
W. Stechow, *Salomon van Ruysdael: Eine Einführung in seine Kunst, mit kritischen Katalog der Gemälde*, 1938, p. 122, no. 457, revised Berlin 1975, p. 139, no. 457.
Art Sales. From early in the eighteenth century to early in the twentieth century, London 1921, vol. III, p. 134

Salomon was the son of the Mennonite cabinetmaker Jacob Jansz de Goyer (c. 1560-1616) from Naarden.[1] Shortly after his father's death, Ruysdael and his brother Isack – the father of the famous landscape painter Jacob van Ruisdael (1628/29-1682) – moved to Haarlem, where Salomon entered the Guild of St Luke in 1623 under the name Salomon de Gooyer. Shortly thereafter he adopted the name Ruysdael from the castle with that name in the Gooiland, which may once have been family a possession. His first dated picture is from 1626, soon followed by three winter scenes from 1627. While first adhering to the new, realistic landscape style of Esaias van de Velde (1587-1630), Salomon quickly elaborated his manner and together with Jan van Goyen (1596-1656) and Pieter de Molyn (1595-1661) created a distinctive landscape art depicting the environs of Haarlem, applying a restricted tonal range and modest subject matter. Sometime before 1627 Ruysdael married Maycke Willemsdr Buyse, also from a

Mennonite family background. Their son Jacob (1629/30-1681) also became a painter. In the next three decades Salomon established himself as a well-to-do Haarlem citizen and a prolific and successful painter who had several pupils, among them his son, his nephew Jacob van Ruysdael (1628/9-1682), and Cornelis Decker (c. 1620-1678). Mayke died in 1660, followed ten years later by her husband, who was buried in Haarlem's Grote or St Bavokerk. Although several history works, and even some still lifes and *batailles* by his hand are known, Van Ruysdael is most of all known as one of the 'classic' masters of Dutch seventeenth century landscape painting. His subject matter included seascapes, winter landscapes, dune landscapes, village views and a wide variety of river landscapes.

Two comparable views by the artist are known, one is on canvas and dated 1664, formerly with T. Agnew Gallery in London in 1938, later with Kunsthandel P. de Boer in Amsterdam in 1954 and sold in auction in 2017.[2] Another one, on panel and measuring 47.5 x 60 cm., was at Kunsthandel Jacques Goudstikker in Amsterdam from 1931 until 1940 and went to the NK Collection (no.1524) in 1945 from where it was restituted to the heirs in 2007 and sold to the Gemäldegalerie in Dresden. These versions both lack the larger building on the right but show at lot of activity on the water and the shore.

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[1] Biography based on I. Van Thiel-Stroman, in: N. Köhler (ed.), *Painting in Haarlem 1500-1850 : The collection of the Frans Hals Museum*, Ghent 2006, pp. 289-293.
[2] Sale Vienna (Dorotheum), 17 October 2017, lot 99.